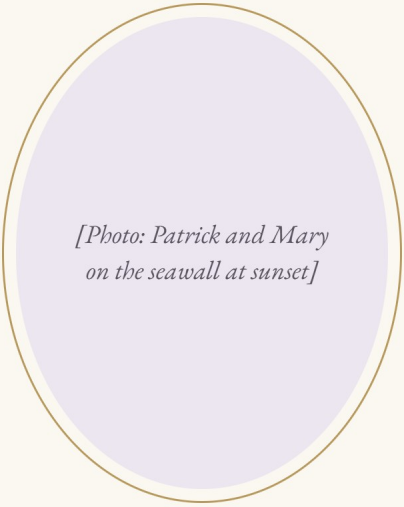
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IN LOVING MEMORY



Patrick Reyes Cabrera

July 20, 1955 · September 24, 2026

Mass of Christian Burial

Tuesday, October 20, 2026 · 10:00 AM

St. John of the Woods Catholic Church

Tacoma, Washington

HIS LIFE

Patrick Reyes Cabrera

Patrick Reyes Cabrera was born on July 20, 1955, in the village of Piti, Guam, to Jose Quenga Cabrera and Ignacia Reyes Acosta Cabrera, one of nine children in a house that was never quiet. Raised in the faith by a grandmother who did not accept excuses, he served as an altar boy at Assumption of Our Lady Church in Piti — a parish founded the very year he was born. Family lore holds that when he came home one Sunday crying over a bloodied shin from a bike wreck, she taped it up and sent him back to Mass. That was Patrick for the rest of his life: you show up, you serve, and you don't make a fuss about it.

In September 1975, fresh out of school, he joined the United States Army. He served twenty years as an infantryman and, from 1988, as a drill sergeant — a job that suited a man who believed a 10 o'clock start meant 10 o'clock. His career carried the family from Germany to Fort Sill, Oklahoma, to Washington, home to Guam, and back to Washington, where he retired in August 1995. Two years later he began a second career with the United States Postal Service, delivering for seventeen years before retiring for good. Two employers in forty years. He was not a man who needed much variety.

He married Mary on June 17, 1985, and they spent forty-one years together. Ask Mary what made him happy and the answer is simple, because he was: breakfast after Sunday Mass, every Sunday, no exceptions. A backyard full of kids and grandkids and a grill full of ribs he refused to write the recipe for. A Minnesota Vikings game on the television — a loyalty he picked up in 1969, when the Vikings were the team Guam got on the air, and never once reconsidered.

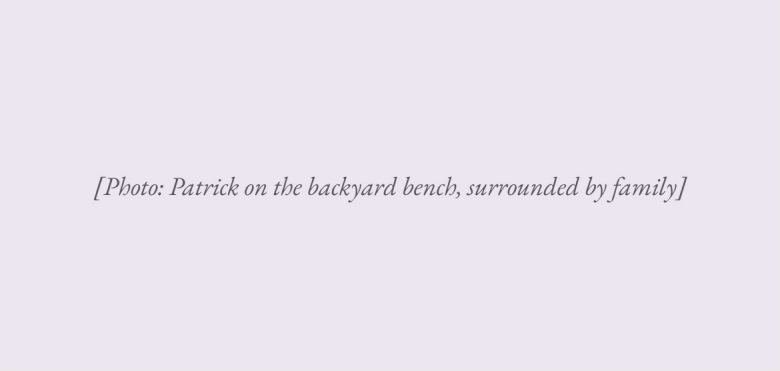
"We used to think it was just another Sunday. He knew better."

He never needed an occasion. What made Patrick happiest was the simplest thing — all of us in the same room on a Sunday afternoon, the kids loud, and later the grandkids underfoot, nobody in a hurry to leave. We used to think it was just another Sunday. He knew better. Those afternoons were the reason for everything else.

His faith was the quiet center of all of it. He and Mary prayed the rosary together every day, and whatever devotion she took up — the Divine Mercy chaplet, the novenas — he was beside her for it. In Germany in 1985, given a temporary house with more bedrooms than they knew what to do with, the family turned one of them into a prayer room. He wanted nothing more for his children and grandchildren than that they would know the Church he loved.

Patrick is survived by his wife, Mary; his children and grandchildren; his siblings; and nieces, nephews, and cousins in Washington, Guam, and beyond. He was preceded in death by his parents and some of his siblings.

He was a simple, humble man who asked for little and gave his family everything. We will miss him at breakfast.



AT A GLANCE

Born	Village of Piti, Guam
Parents	Jose Quenga Cabrera and Ignacia Reyes Acosta Cabrera
Married	Mary, June 17, 1985 — 41 years
U.S. Army	1975–1995 · Infantry, Drill Sergeant
U.S. Postal Service	1997–2014
His team	Minnesota Vikings, since 1969
His Sunday	Mass, then breakfast

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2026

Order of Service

Celebrants: Fr. Tuan, Pastor, and Fr. Hendry

BEFORE MASS · 9:00 AM

Holy Rosary	*Led by the family*
Family Time with Patrick	*Until Mass begins*

INTRODUCTORY RITES · 10:00 AM

Opening Hymn	*[Hymn TBA]*
Greeting and Placing of the Pall	

LITURGY OF THE WORD

First Reading	*1 Thessalonians 4:13–14 · [Reader]*
Responsorial Psalm	*[Psalm TBA]*
Second Reading	*[Reading TBA] · [Reader]*
Gospel	*John 14:1–3*
Homily	*Fr. Tuan*
Prayers of the Faithful	*[Reader]*

LITURGY OF THE EUCHARIST

Holy Communion	*[Communion Hymn TBA]*

FINAL COMMENDATION

Words of Remembrance	*Vincent Calip, then family and friends*
Final Commendation	*Fr. Tuan*
Closing Hymn	*[Hymn TBA]*

The Readings

FIRST READING

1 Thessalonians 4:13–14

Saint Paul writes to people mourning someone they love: we grieve, but not without hope, because those who have died in Jesus will rise with him.

RESPONSORIAL PSALM

[Psalm and response, to be confirmed]

SECOND READING

[Reading, to be confirmed]

GOSPEL

John 14:1–3

Jesus tells his friends not to be troubled. There are many rooms in his Father's house, and he has gone ahead to prepare a place for them.

☆

Interment with Military Honors

Friday, October 23, 2026 · 10:00 AM
Tahoma National Cemetery · Kent, Washington

Please arrive by 9:30 AM. The cemetery runs on a strict military schedule and cannot hold a service for late arrivals. Allow extra time for Friday morning traffic and construction.

Because Patrick served twenty years in the U.S. Army, he will receive military honors: a short ceremony by uniformed service members that usually includes the playing of Taps and the folding of the American flag, presented to the family. Everyone is welcome.

◇

Si Yu'os Ma'åse'

CHamoru for "thank you" — a wish that God's mercy be with you.

The family of Patrick Cabrera thanks everyone who has surrounded us with prayers, food, and presence these past weeks. Your kindness reflects the man we are honoring. To the family who traveled to be with us, some of you from Guam, thank you for coming so far.

Special thanks to Fr. Tuan, Fr. Hendry, the St. John of the Woods Lazarus Ministry, and the staff of Mountain View Funeral Home.

Mary, Roxy, Monique, Vincent, and the Cabrera family

Eternal rest grant unto him, O Lord,
and let perpetual light shine upon him.
May he rest in peace. Amen.



FROM PITI, GUAM

Share a memory of Patrick, find service details, or help the family.

cabrera-memorial.com

Patrick Reyes Cabrera

1955 – 2026